

- **May 18, 1860** Nominated as the Republican candidate for president.
- **November 6, 1860** Elected as 16th president of the United States, receiving almost 40 percent of the popular vote and 180 of 303 possible electoral college votes.
- **December 20, 1860** South Carolina secedes from the Union, followed within two months by Mississippi, Florida, Alabama, Georgia, Louisiana, and Texas.
- **March 4, 1861** Lincoln delivers his first inaugural address in Washington, D.C.
- **April 12, 1861** Confederate artillery fires on Fort Sumter in Charleston. Civil War begins.
- **April 15, 1861** Lincoln calls for 75,000 volunteers to restore the Union.
- **April 17, 1861** Virginia secedes, followed by North Carolina, Tennessee, and Arkansas.
- **February 20, 1862** Lincoln's third son, Willie, dies at age 11. His wife is emotionally devastated by the loss and never fully recovers.
- **January 1, 1863** Issues the Emancipation Proclamation.
- **November 19, 1863** Delivers a carefully drafted speech at the dedication of the Soldiers' National Cemetery—the Gettysburg Address.
- **November 8, 1864** Re-elected as president, receiving 55 percent of the popular vote and 212 out of 233 electoral votes.